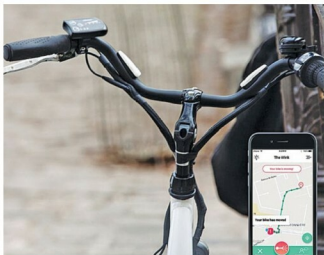




Nanoleaf triangular smart light panels



Wink Bar—a connected handlebar with GPS for bicycles



Quartz self-cleaning bottle for water purification

Startups

Let's start with startups. Every major event is giving lots of attention to startup entrepreneurs—be it *GITEX* (Dubai), *CES* or *Global Sources Electronics* show. Nearly 1000 startups demonstrated their innovative ideas and products at CES. Some of the novel and exciting products developed by them are quite remarkable.

Big Boy team from Belgium has developed and patented a camera and audio system that can see and hear like humans, recording in 3D and streaming content to virtual reality (VR) headsets—to be used for surgery, psychology, technical training, education and entertainment.

Robomart from Santa Clara, California is planning a fleet of on-demand,

autonomous, self-driving small truck-like stores for grocery retailers, much like vending machines. These will help people buy at their door-step instead of going to the market. Customers could call the closest vehicle to their address using an app.

Velco from Paris, France has designed Wink Bar, the first connected handlebar with GPS for bicycles, which are a very popular mode of transport in Europe but often get stolen. The GPS helps in tracking your bike anywhere and ensuring you never get lost. The Bar can be attached by bicycle manufacturers to their bikes to make them smart.

Stream from Amsterdam, Netherlands can provide secure Wi-Fi hotspots with embedded cloud SIM

technology for travellers who, at present, have to depend on unsecured data transmissions (that can be hacked) from public places.

Zhor-Tech from Nancy, France has developed smart shoes that use sensors and algorithms to warm your feet in snow, detect fatigue or a disease, and even help stop drunken driving.

Quartz water bottles (half-litre) use UV-C light to purify water in a minute's time so it can be safely consumed. It intelligently activates every four hours. Once charged, it can be used for 2-3 months.

Nanoleaf triangular smart light panels produce millions of colours in sync with music of your choice. These can be linked to each other to produce a shape of your choice.